NSW GOVERNMENT

NSW Recovery Plan

Supporting plan of the NSW State Emergency Management Plan

Updated December 2023



NSW Recovery Plan

Cover image: *Sunrise over the Macquarie River, Dubbo, in Wiradjuri Country.* © Zetter.

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Authorisation

The NSW Recovery Plan 2023 has been prepared under the provisions of the NSW State Emergency and Rescue Management Act 1989 (SERM Act) and in accordance with the NSW State Emergency Management Plan (EMPLAN). This plan is authorised by the NSW Government Minister responsible for Emergency Services and the State Emergency Recovery Controller (SERCON) who has responsibility for overseeing the preparation and maintenance of recovery policies, arrangements and plans for NSW.

This plan is a supporting plan to the EMPLAN. It was approved by the SERCON on 9 February 2024 and endorsed by the NSW State Emergency Management Committee on 13 December 2023.

- Simone Walker, State Emergency Recovery Controller



Healing together by Monique Rennie

Acknowledgement of Country

The NSW Government acknowledges the Traditional Custodians of the lands where we work and live. We celebrate the diversity of Aboriginal peoples and their ongoing cultures and connections to the lands and waters of NSW.

We pay our respects to Elders past and present and acknowledge the Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people who contributed to the development of the NSW Recovery Plan 2023.

Healing Together

The artwork 'Healing together' was created by Monique Rennie, a proud Kamillaroi woman living on Wonnarua country in the NSW Upper Hunter. It illustrates organisations and communities joining together to find the strength to recover and rebuild after a natural disaster or significant event. At the centre of the artwork sits our communities and organisations coming together to discuss ways to recover. The artwork features gum leaves branching in from the corners and embracing the communities, providing their healing and growing together. Around the artwork are lemon myrtle blooms healing the families in their centre and grass tree flowers representing the flourishing that can happen after hardship.

Acronyms

Acronym	Full Title
AIDR	Australian Institute for Disaster Resilience
ANZEMC	Australian and New Zealand Emergency Management Committee
CN	Community Network
DRFA	Disaster Recovery Funding Arrangements
DSERCON	Deputy State Emergency Recovery Controller
EMPLAN	NSW State Emergency Management Plan
EOCON	Emergency Operations Controller
LEMC	Local Emergency Management Committee
LEMO	Local Emergency Management Officer
LEOCON	Local Emergency Operations Controller
LGA	Local Government Area
NEMA	National Emergency Management Agency
RA	NSW Reconstruction Authority
REMC	Regional Emergency Management Committee
REMO	Regional Emergency Management Officer
REOCON	Regional Emergency Operations Controller
RPIC	Recovery Public Information Coordinator
SEMC	NSW State Emergency Management Committee
SEOC	State Emergency Operations Centre
SEOCON	State Emergency Operations Controller
SERCON	State Emergency Recovery Controller
SERM Act	*State Emergency and Rescue Management Act 1989*
SRC	State Recovery Committee
SRRG	Social Recovery Reference Group
The Act	*NSW Reconstruction Authority Act 2022*
The Plan	NSW Recovery Plan

Quick reference icons


Important definition


Key legislation


Committees and community networks


Roles and responsibilities of government


Key leadership roles


Key funding information


Handover and transition processes


Key documents


Mental health support


Temporary accommodation

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1

Introduction, Aims, Context and Legislative Framework

1.1 Introduction

New South Wales is rich with diversity of people, history, culture, and landscapes. Covering more than 800,000km^2, 8.2 million people call the state home with forecast growth putting the population at 10 million by 2041.

NSW's striking natural topography and a changing climate can make regions and communities more susceptible to disasters of increasing frequency and magnitude. Since 2019, the impact of disasters and emergencies on NSW communities, local economies, infrastructure, and the natural environment has been unprecedented.

Every Local Government Area has been affected by an emergency or natural disaster in recent years. Many NSW communities were devastatingly impacted by the catastrophic 2021-22 flood events, in particular the Northern Rivers and the Central West. Others are still recovering from the 2019-20 Black Summer bushfires, while the COVID-19 pandemic has fundamentally changed the way we live and work.

The increased frequency and intensity of disasters and other emergencies challenge how we collectively prepare, respond and recover. There is growing recognition that a greater emphasis on preparedness and planning, rather than reactive emergency management, is key to reducing risk and the impact on communities.

NSW Communities

Recovery from disaster follows the response and immediate relief phase. It encompasses coordinated support across four key domains – social, built, economic and environmental. At the centre of these four domains is community.

Communities across NSW are diverse. Roughly 66% of the state's population lives in Greater Sydney, with 44% of us living in regional, rural and remote locations.

Just over a quarter of the state's residents were born overseas, 275 different languages are spoken and there are 144 religions practiced.

NSW has Australia's largest population of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people, making up 3.4% of the state's population, with a younger median age compared to NSW's non-Aboriginal population.

Overall, we have an ageing population as people live longer and families have fewer children.

More than 1.3 million people in NSW live with disability and a 2020–2022 national study showed 40% of respondents are living with a lifetime mental health disorder.

NSW has a diversified, service driven economy, with strong rates of labour force participation following the pandemic-driven declines of recent years. But rates of economic disadvantage are disproportionately high for certain demographic groups and geographic locations, and inequality in NSW has widened between the most recent and previous census.

Beyond the statistics, NSW communities are unique. Each has their own history, culture, local assets and sense of place. Each has their own strengths and faces their own challenges.

Community-centred recovery is responsive to these unique attributes, harnessing local strengths, assets and know-how, along with existing networks and connections. It recognises the importance of agency in the recovery process and that communities are best placed to define their own recovery goals.

NSW Recovery Plan 2023

The NSW Recovery Plan 2023 has been developed to guide coordination across government agencies and with other stakeholders – local councils, industries, businesses, non-government organisations, community groups and others on the ground – for the delivery of successful recovery.

Recovery can be a complex and lengthy process. The time it takes a community to recover can vary depending on the scale of the disaster, the level of preparation and resourcing, inequities that may already exist, and the extent of social cohesion, connection and community assets.

The NSW Government plays a key role in recovery, with decision making, resource allocation and program delivery responsibilities across four domains. This role must be guided by local know-how and understanding, and be responsive to local need, driven by local priorities and enabling of ground-up efforts.

This plan is intended to guide a collaborative and flexible approach whereby government roles and responsibilities align with and complement community-centred approaches and the efforts of other recovery partners to get communities back on their feet.

> 'Recovered' is being able to lead a life that individuals and communities value living, even if it is different from the life they were living before the event (AIDR).

Community-centred recovery and resilience framework

Embedding a community-centred approach is an ongoing process. The next step for the NSW Reconstruction Authority is to collaborate with key community stakeholders to develop a community-centred recovery and resilience framework.

This framework will guide and strengthen our collective approach to leveraging, supporting and developing community knowledge, leadership and resilience. It will foster stronger partnerships between government, local stakeholders and impacted communities, to enable more coordinated approaches underpinned by shared responsibility.

The new framework will include strategies to support Aboriginal communities to lead their own recovery, and to ensure that those most at risk are not left further behind.

1.2 Aims

The NSW Recovery Plan 2023 strives to:

- be a practical, action-orientated document for key recovery activities
- ensure recovery planning and activities are community-centred and align with the National Principles of Disaster Recovery
- provide a collaborative, coordinated, adaptable and scalable approach to recovery activities, to achieve optimum community outcomes that match community need
- incorporate actions to reduce future risks, as guided by the State Disaster Mitigation Plan and documented in local Disaster Adaptation Plans
- outline governance structures at the local, regional and state level to plan and prepare for emergencies and recovery
- inform the development of other recovery plans and tools in NSW
- define the triggers and process for the transition from response to recovery
- articulate the roles and responsibilities of Recovery Coordinators
- define the roles and responsibilities of recovery partners and agencies within NSW that play a role in emergency management, and the handover of responsibility back to the community at the appropriate time.

1.3 Context

1.3.1. The NSW Recovery Plan (the Plan) is prepared and maintained by the NSW Reconstruction Authority. The NSW Recovery Plan is an all-hazards plan.

1.3.2. The Plan provides the framework for recovery in New South Wales and can be tailored to the requirements and scale of each disaster, emergency or community, supporting the affected community through its recovery.

1.3.3. The Plan recognises that localised, community-driven recovery efforts begin immediately following disasters or emergencies. These efforts will often commence before formal and structured recovery efforts begin and it is the primary role of formal recovery activities to support these immediate efforts.

1.3.4. Make safe (for example, clearing hazardous trees or debris) and priority works to critical assets and infrastructure (for instance, energy, water, sewerage, gas) relevant to public safety and humanitarian necessity will often be undertaken by combat agencies prior to the activation of formal recovery activities.

1.3.5. The 2023 Plan is consistent with the SERM Act and is a supporting plan of the NSW State Emergency Management Plan (EMPLAN). It was developed alongside the EMPLAN and the State Disaster Mitigation Plan.

1.3.6. The Plan is supported by local Pre-Event Recovery Plans and guidance documents that inform recovery readiness, activations and announcements.

1.4 Legislative Framework

State Emergency and Rescue Management Act 1989

1.4.1. Under the State Emergency and Rescue Management Act 1989 (SERM Act), the Minister for Emergency Services (the Minister) is responsible for:

- **a.** Ensuring that adequate measures are taken by government agencies to prevent, prepare for, respond to, and assist recovery from emergencies
- **b.** Coordinating the activities of government agencies in taking those measures (Part 2, Division 1, Subdivision 1, Section 10), and
- **c.** Appointing a State Emergency Recovery Controller (SERCON) and Deputy State Emergency Recovery Controller (DSERCON) (Part 2, Division 1, Subdivision 5).

1.4.2. Subdivision 5 of the SERM Act establishes the role of the SERCON. Responsibility for the overall coordination of recovery operations in NSW rests with the SERCON, unless prescribed in hazard-specific plans. (Source: EMPLAN)

1.4.3. The SERCON has the delegation to direct agencies, including local council, to undertake actions in recovery. (Source: SERM Act, Part 2, Division 1, Subdivision 5, Section 20B)

1.4.4. The SERCON has the authority to engage the support of government agencies as required and to engage with industry, non-government organisations (NGOs), local and the Australian Government, as necessary, to contribute to the recovery process.

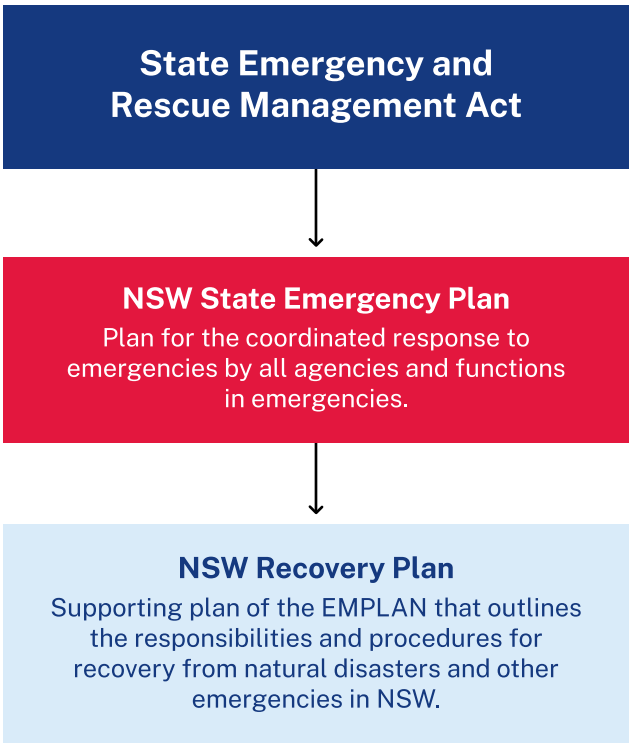


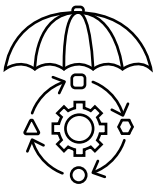
Figure 1: Legislation and policy framework of NSW emergency management arrangements

1.5 NSW Reconstruction Authority Act 2022

1.5.1. The NSW Reconstruction Authority Act 2022 ('the Act') aims to promote community resilience to the impact of disasters in New South Wales through:

- Disaster prevention, preparedness, and adaptation, and
- Recovery and reconstruction following disasters.

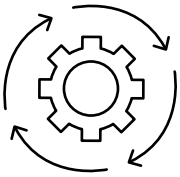
1.5.2. To achieve this aim, the Act has established the NSW Reconstruction Authority ('the RA'), which leads four key disaster functions:



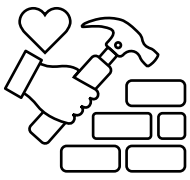
Mitigation and adaptation, including public infrastructure, homes, and land use planning



Local preparedness, including education and community information



Community-centred recovery



Long-term rebuilding and reconstruction

1.6 Other Legislation

1.6.1. Other legal powers exist within government agencies' legislation to enable and support recovery. For example, the Community Welfare Act 1987 and the Protection of the Environment Operations Act 1997.

1.6.2. The Government Sector Employment Act 2013 provides for the temporary secondment of staff (Part 5, Section 66). This mechanism can be used by the SERCON to support all aspects of recovery, including recovery operations and other support.

2

Scope, Principles and Community-Centred Recovery

2.1 Defining Recovery



2.1.1. The *State Emergency and Rescue Management Act 1989* defines recovery as:

> …the process of returning an affected community to its proper level of functioning after an emergency.

2.1.2. Under this Plan, the definition is expanded to recognise the complexity, breadth, and timeframes of recovery, and is defined as:

> …[involving] the coordinated process of supporting affected communities in the reconstruction of the built environment and the restoration of emotional, social, economic, built and natural environment wellbeing.

(Source: AIDR)

2.2 Scope



2.2.1. Under Section 20B of the SERM Act, the RA's CEO (or a person designated by the CEO that is either a senior executive in the RA or NSW Police Force) is recognised as the State Emergency Recovery Controller (SERCON) with general responsibility for controlling recovery in NSW following emergencies. While the SERM Act recognises that another agency may be better placed to lead recovery following certain emergencies, it also empowers the SERCON to assume responsibility for those emergencies, as required.

2.2.2. It is the RA's role to lead and coordinate recovery in NSW following disasters as defined in the NSW Reconstruction Authority Act 2022 and emergencies affecting more than one region, as defined in the SERM Act. It is recognised that while these are distinct roles, there is a high degree of overlap and commonality.

2.2.3. In support of the SERCON, the RA can take an all-hazards approach to recovery, relying on its broad function in Section 10 of the NSW Reconstruction Authority Act 2022 and noting that any emergency or hazard can be brought within the definition of disaster in the Act, should the need arise.

2.2.4. Disaster is defined in Section 6 of the NSW Reconstruction Authority Act 2022 to mean:

- **a.** natural disasters, including, for example, bush fires, coastal hazards, cyclones, earthquakes, floods, heatwaves, landslides, severe thunderstorms, tornadoes and tsunamis
- **b.** hazards caused by natural disasters including air pollution, water and soil contamination and water insecurity
- **c.** other emergencies in relation to which the Minister has requested assistance from the RA
- **d.** other emergencies in relation to which—
  - a public authority, including a Minister other than the Minister administering this Act, has requested assistance from the RA, and
  - the RA has agreed to provide assistance
- **e.** events, incidents or matters, or classes of events, incidents or matters, prescribed by the regulations.

2.2.5. The RA has extensive recovery functions described in Section 10 of the NSW Reconstruction Authority Act 2022, including those listed below:

a. reconstruction and recovery following disasters and other emergencies, including—

- assisting the Minister administering the SERM Act and the SERCON to exercise the Minister's and Controller's functions in relation to recovery under that Act
- facilitating, coordinating and directing the recovery, planning and rebuilding of affected communities, including repairing and rebuilding land and infrastructure and other development
- balancing constraints to enable a focused, timely and expedited recovery of affected communities

b. information provision and exchange and community engagement, including—

- supporting collaboration and coordination between government agencies, local councils, service providers and communities to improve disaster prevention, preparedness, recovery, reconstruction and adaptation
- increasing the flow of information and enabling community participation to support the development of strategies for disaster prevention, preparedness, recovery, reconstruction and adaptation

c. to coordinate the development and implementation of whole-of-government policies for ensuring communities can recover, reconstruct, and adapt effectively and efficiently following disasters

d. to lead the management and coordination of housing and infrastructure renewal and recovery within affected communities

e. to work closely with affected communities to ensure the needs of each community are recognised in the recovery and reconstruction of the community, and to improve the disaster preparedness and resilience of communities

f. to carry out research and provide advice, proposals, recommendations and reports to the Minister about recovery and reconstruction following disasters

g. to enter into joint ventures, project delivery agreements and other arrangements with landowners, developers, state and Commonwealth government agencies and local councils in relation to disaster prevention, recovery and reconstruction

h. to implement funding schemes to provide financial support in relation to disaster prevention, recovery, and reconstruction

i. to exercise other functions conferred or imposed on the RA by or under this Act or any other Act

j. to do anything supplementary, incidental or consequential on the exercise of the RA's functions.

2.2.6. The RA's recovery functions do not limit the functions of any other agency under the SERM Act (Section 10(2) of the Act).

2.3 Principles for Disaster Recovery

2.3.1. Disaster recovery is part of emergency management and includes phases of prevention, preparedness, and response. Planning for recovery is integral to emergency preparation. Furthermore, mitigation and adaptation activities may be initiated as part of recovery to reduce future disaster risk.

2.3.2. Disaster risk is recognised as the consequence of the interactions between hazard and the conditions that make people, places and assets vulnerable and exposed.

2.3.3. Vulnerability is defined as 'the characteristics of a person or group and their situation that influence their capacity to anticipate, cope with, resist and recover from the impact of a hazard' (AIDR 2022). More broadly, vulnerability can also be used to describe the characteristics of places, assets and infrastructure.

2.3.4. The impacts of disasters and other emergencies can exacerbate vulnerabilities, such as social inequalities, which can reduce a community's ability to recover.

2.3.5. Recovery presents an opportunity to reduce risks and strengthen community resilience. During recovery the community may learn about the risks it faces and may apply this knowledge to build resilience and capacity to withstand future shocks.

2.3.6. Disaster recovery activities must support community development by addressing pre-existing vulnerabilities across the four domains of recovery. Addressing the causes of vulnerabilities in community recovery supports the development of resilience within communities. Recovery activities and programs must support sustainable and equitable outcomes and reduce disaster risk.

2.3.7. Disaster risk is recognised as the consequence of the interactions between hazards and the conditions that make people, places and assets vulnerable and exposed.

2.3.8. Successful risk reduction decreases the impacts of events and the cost and time required for recovery. Prevention can reduce or avoid an event impact and minimise longer term recovery requirements.

2.3.9. The Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015-2030 (Sendai Framework) also supports disaster risk reduction. It recognises that government has the primary role to reduce disaster risk, but that responsibility should be shared with other stakeholders including local councils, NGOs and other stakeholders. The Sendai Framework can be accessed here.

2.3.10. The Australian Institute for Disaster Resilience (AIDR) promotes the six National Principles for Disaster Recovery that are incorporated into NSW recovery planning:



1. **Understand the context:** Successful recovery is based on understanding community context, with each community having its own history, values and dynamics.



2. **Recognise the complexity:** Successful recovery is responsive to the complex and dynamic nature of both emergencies and the community.



3. **Use community-centred approaches:** Successful recovery is community-centred, responsive, and flexible, engaging with community and supporting them to move forward.



4. **Coordinate all approaches:** Successful recovery requires a planned, coordinated, and adaptive approach between community and partner agencies, based on continuing assessment of impacts and needs.



5. **Communicate effectively:** Successful recovery is built on effective communication between the affected community and other partners.



6. **Recognise and build capacity:** Successful recovery recognises, supports, and builds on individual, community and organisational capacity and resilience.

2.4 Community-Centred Recovery

2.4.1. Effective recovery requires a thorough understanding of the community and its central role in leading its recovery. Planning must enable those impacted to participate in all stages of the recovery process and across the four recovery domains (refer to Figure 2) to integrate response and recovery activities.

2.4.2. The four recovery domains emphasise the reconstruction of buildings and infrastructure, restoration of economic, emotional, and physical wellbeing of communities and the restoration of the natural environment. In NSW, restoration of the natural environment includes restoring associated infrastructure and heritage sites, and the management of pollution and contamination.

2.4.3. A community-centred approach is collaborative, enabling and supporting communities and individuals to participate in the development of recovery goals and outcomes that are community specific and meet the unique recovery needs of impacted communities.

2.4.4. Community-centred recovery recognises the diversity of communities and the need to foster inclusive, culturally appropriate approaches to deliver equitable 'whole-of-community' recovery outcomes.

2.4.5. Community-centred recovery acknowledges and respects Aboriginal expertise as central to recovery for Aboriginal communities; and that connection to Country, culture and community can be profoundly impacted by disasters, while also being a source of strength and resilience in the recovery process.

2.4.6. Agencies should support and coordinate with Aboriginal Elders, leaders, community controlled organisations and landowners, including Local Aboriginal Land Councils, to strengthen engagement and ensure their significant land, community assets, cultural ties and knowledge are recognised and factored into recovery (and at all stages of an emergency).

2.4.7. People's ability to prepare for and withstand the effects of disaster may be constrained by a range of life circumstances. Community-centred recovery recognises the importance of working in partnership with people with lived experience whose voices can often be overlooked, including people with disability, children and young people, older people, and those living in isolated and remote communities.

2.4.8. It is important that the NSW Government works with individuals and groups, and partners with the services that support and advocate for them, to identify action-oriented strategies to increase access, inclusion and equitable outcomes when planning for and coordinating recovery.

2.4.9. A dedicated community-centred recovery and resilience framework developed by the RA will guide and strengthen the NSW Government approach to leveraging, supporting, and developing community knowledge, leadership, and resilience to disasters and other emergencies.

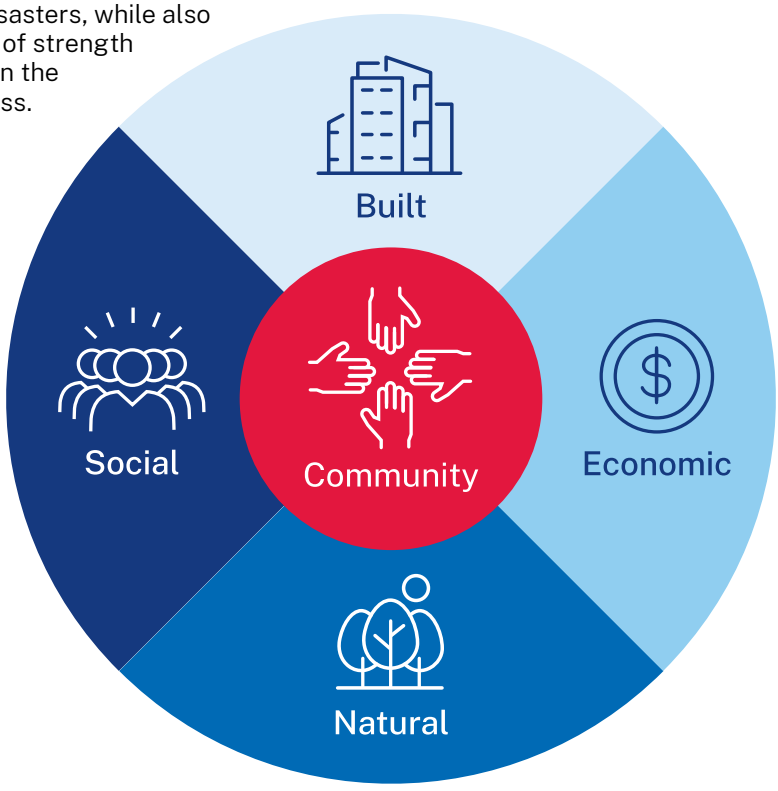


Figure 2: Community-centred recovery focuses on recovery needs segmented into four domains

3

Governance Structures and Committees

3.1 Governance Structures

3.1.1. Governance structures exist at national, state and local levels of government to plan and prepare for emergencies and recovery.

3.1.2. Governance structures for recovery operations are scalable, flexible and designed to allow the escalation of unresolved issues, risks and threats. Escalation is determined by the scale of the event.

3.1.3. Depending on the scale, the type of event and community needs, one or a mixture of appropriate governance structures can be utilised.

3.1.4. Management of a recovery operation, including the coordination of services, information and resources, should take place at the local level where possible.

3.1.5. In small-scale events, this would be achieved by allowing the Local Recovery Committee to take the lead and seek advice and guidance from relevant government agencies as required.

3.1.6. When events overwhelm local capacity, the NSW Government, through the NSW Reconstruction Authority will coordinate recovery operations in partnership with local council and via collaboration with impacted communities.

3.1.7. In these circumstances, the Local and/or Regional Recovery Committee play a critical role in recovery efforts because members have key knowledge, connections and understanding of the community.

3.1.8. Where appropriate the RA may convene an Elected Officials Working Group to enable elected officials (of local government, the NSW Government and the Australian Government) to:

- represent community needs and issues directly to the relevant recovery committee
- be a conduit of information on recovery back to the community and/or,
- facilitate a channel for issues to be resolved by the relevant recovery committee.

3.1.9. Local, regional and state governance structures do not operate in isolation and effective communication between them is critical.

3.2 Local Structures

3.2.1. The SERM Act recognises that the involvement of local councils in all stages of an emergency is critical. This includes in prevention, preparation, response and recovery. Therefore, the emergency management structure and arrangements at the local level are based on the local government areas (LGAs) or combined LGAs.

3.2.2. The Local Emergency Management Committee (LEMC) is responsible for the preparation of plans relating to emergency prevention, preparation, response and recovery in the LGA (noting both combat agencies and the RA have separate planning responsibilities).

3.2.3. LEMCs and Local Recovery Committees must develop relationships and build trust with Aboriginal communities (including Discrete Aboriginal Communities) to support an inclusive and culturally safe approach to emergency and recovery planning and the delivery of recovery services. that is community-centred.

3.2.4. Consistent with local engagement structures detailed in the SERM Act, the RA has the function of improving recovery outcomes by supporting collaboration and coordination between government agencies, local councils, service providers and community in relation to information sharing and community engagement.

3.3 Local Recovery Committee

3.3.1. During the response phase, the RA will receive a briefing from the Emergency Operations Centre (EOC) or Combat Agency Control Centre regarding recovery implications and will consider the need to establish a Local Recovery Committee. The RA will consider impact assessments to determine recovery arrangements and needs.

3.3.2. The Local Recovery Committee is the strategic decision-making body for local recovery. It provides visible and strong leadership and has a key role in restoring community confidence. This is achieved by assessing the consequences of the emergency and coordinating activities to rebuild, restore and rehabilitate the social, built, economic and natural environments of the affected community.

3.3.3. The combat agency and Local Emergency Operations Controller (LEOCON) will attend initial meetings of a Local Recovery Committee, to provide an overview of the situation.

3.3.4. The Local Recovery Committee will be chaired by a local council delegate. If local council elects not to chair, a Recovery Coordinator will assume this responsibility.

3.3.5. Other representatives, not specifically designated as members of LEMCs, should be part of a Local Recovery Committee to ensure an inclusive approach. It should include local representatives from key stakeholders in the recovery process (government and non-government, local businesses, social service organisations and functional areas). Consideration should also be given to including representatives of relevant Community Networks and/or any other pre-existing community groups.

3.3.6. The Local Recovery Committee will:

- **a.** represent the local community
- **b.** conduct and update the Recovery Needs Assessment
- **c.** assess the need for a Recovery Centre or Recovery Assistance Point and recommend to the SERCON or Recovery Coordinator
- **d.** guide decisions about local priorities and resource allocation and management, referring to the Pre-Event Recovery Plan
- **e.** assess the need for one or more local recovery subcommittees to focus on one or more recovery domains
- **f.** develop and maintain a Recovery Action Plan with an agreed strategy for ongoing recovery
- **g.** liaise with the community and other stakeholders and coordinate local recovery activities in partnership with the NSW Reconstruction Authority or Recovery Coordinator
- **h.** communicate effectively with Regional and State Recovery Committees, if activated
- **i.** ensure that relevant stakeholders and the community are involved in the development and implementation of Recovery Action Plans and are informed of progress
- **j.** ensure the recovery aligns with the National Principles of Disaster Recovery
- **k.** support the SERCON to undertake program monitoring and evaluation.

3.3.7. The Local Recovery Committee retains responsibility for strategic decision-making regarding local recovery. The committee communicates regularly with the RA or the Recovery Coordinator to ensure that local recovery activities complement and align with the activities of the state.

3.3.8. The local council is responsible for prioritising its own resources to contribute to the recovery objectives that are identified by the Local Recovery Committee, in the Pre-Event Recovery Plan and Recovery Action Plan. This effort should align with the work of the RA or Recovery Coordinator.

3.4 Regional Structures

3.4.1. For the purposes of the SERM Act, the state is divided into such regions as the Minister may determine.

3.4.2. The Regional Emergency Management Committee (REMC) is responsible for preparing and reviewing plans in relation to the prevention of, preparation for, response to and recovery from emergencies in the region for which it is constituted.

3.4.3. In accordance with the EMPLAN, a Regional Recovery Committee may be formed to coordinate the recovery effort if an emergency affects several LGAs.

3.4.4. REMCs and Regional Recovery Committees must consider any specific needs of Aboriginal communities (including Discrete Aboriginal Communities) in emergency and recovery planning and the delivery of recovery services.

3.4.5. The SERCON may send a representative to the REMC.

3.5 Regional Recovery Committee

3.5.1. If an emergency affects several LGAs, the RA will receive a briefing from the relevant Emergency Operations Centre (EOC) or Combat Agency Control Centre regarding recovery implications and will consider the need to establish a Regional Recovery Committee. The RA will consider any impact assessments in determining the need for recovery arrangements.

3.5.2. The Regional Recovery Committee will be chaired by a Recovery Coordinator.

3.5.3. The composition of the Regional Recovery Committee will be determined according to the nature and scale of the event, however delegates from each functional area should be encouraged to attend.

3.5.4. The combat agency controller and Regional Emergency Operations Controller (REOCON) will attend initial Regional Recovery Committee meetings to provide an overview of the situation.

3.5.5. The Regional Recovery Committee will:

- **a.** coordinate a cohesive approach to recovery activities across multiple LGAs
- **b.** ensure effective communication between the Regional Recovery Committee and Local Recovery Committees
- **c.** ensure effective communication with the State Recovery Committee
- **d.** provide advice and guidance to assist community-centred recovery
- **e.** support the work of the Recovery Coordinator
- **f.** guide decisions about priorities and resource allocation and management
- **g.** develop and maintain a Recovery Action Plan with an agreed strategy for ongoing recovery
- **h.** ensure that relevant stakeholders and the community are involved in the development and implementation of Recovery Action Plans and informed of progress
- **i.** ensure the recovery is aligned with the National Principles for Disaster Recovery
- **j.** support the SERCON to undertake program monitoring and evaluation.

3.5.6. Where a Regional Recovery Committee is established, the Recovery Coordinator and their team will provide support, guidance and resources to assist with the implementation of recovery activities. The Recovery Coordinator remains responsible for coordinating state recovery operations in the field.

3.5.7. In circumstances where a Regional Recovery Committee is established, the NSW Recovery Plan recognises that resources may be stretched and that delegates may need to be redirected from attendance at Local Recovery Committees. The flow of information between committees becomes even more critical in such circumstances.

3.6 State Structures

3.6.1. The NSW State Emergency Management Committee (SEMC) that is established under the SERM Act has responsibilities that include, but are not limited to:

- **a.** emergency planning for NSW
- **b.** facilitating the development of emergency and recovery management capabilities
- **c.** endorsing supporting plans, including Pre-Event Recovery Plans
- **d.** ensuring appropriate linkages with federal arrangements where relevant.

3.7 State Recovery Committee

3.7.1. The NSW State Recovery Committee is established under the EMPLAN and provides strategic oversight and guidance to recovery efforts following disasters that overwhelm local and regional capacity. This may occur through one large-scale event or through several disasters or emergencies that occur simultaneously.

3.7.2. The State Recovery Committee (SRC) is a standing committee which will continue to meet while communities remain in recovery.

3.7.3. The SRC will be chaired by the SERCON.

3.7.4. The SRC is responsible for:

- **a.** providing strategic direction in relation to disaster recovery
- **b.** considering funding packages for recovery programs and services, guided by local/regional priorities, needs assessments, and desired recovery outcomes
- **c.** establishing subcommittees to lead delivery across functions
- **d.** overseeing reconstruction and recovery efforts
- **e.** oversight and management of strategic risks in recovery
- **f.** providing senior leadership to facilitate whole-of-government coordination
- **g.** facilitating the accurate and timely flow of information, reports and responding to requests for escalations from Local and Regional Recovery Committees and the NSW Government
- **h.** monitoring and reporting to standing committees and the NSW Reconstruction Authority Advisory Board, as required
- **i.** identifying, cataloguing and oversighting lessons management processes.

3.7.5. The RA provides executive support to the SRC.

3.7.6. The SRC comprises delegates drawn from the subcommittees as well as a range of government agencies, local bodies and others, as determined by the nature and scale of the event.

3.7.7. In the case of subcommittees, both the Chair and Deputy Chair are encouraged to attend as delegates.

3.7.8. The Plan recognises that resources may be stretched and that delegates may need to be redirected from attendance at Local and Regional Recovery Committees to the SRC.

3.7.9. Local and Regional Recovery Committees should prioritise the submission of information to the SRC as this information is part of the intelligence that directly informs program development and the deployment of state resources to support impacted communities.

3.7.10. At a minimum, SRC delegates are typically drawn from the range of sources outlined below.

- SERCON (Chair)
- SEOCON
- Aboriginal Affairs NSW
- Animal and Agriculture subcommittee
- Australian Defence Force
- Business, Industry and Tourism subcommittee
- Department of Communities and Justice
- Department of Customer Service
- Department of Education
- Department of Regional NSW
- Fire and Rescue NSW
- Funding subcommittee
- Health and Wellbeing subcommittee
- Infrastructure subcommittee
- Insurance Council of Australia
- Local Government NSW
- Multicultural NSW
- NSW Police Force
- NSW Reconstruction Authority
- NSW Rural Fire Service
- NSW State Emergency Service
- NSW Telecommunications Authority
- NSW Treasury
- Office of Local Government
- Premier's Department
- Regional Recovery Committees
- Service NSW
- Temporary Housing subcommittee
- The Cabinet Office
- Waste and Environment subcommittee
- Any others as determined by the nature and scale of the event.

3.7.11. When the nature or scale of the event dictates the need for additional delegates, they are often drawn from the following sources:

- Emergency Information Coordination Unit
- Crown Lands – Housing and Property
- Public Information Functional Area
- Telecommunications Functional Area
- Transport Services Functional Area
- Health Services Functional Area
- Energy and Utilities Functional Area
- Engineering Services Functional Area
- Environmental Services Functional Area
- Welfare Services Functional Area
- Homes NSW.

3.7.12. The SRC may change the formation or function of the subcommittees to meet the requirements of the recovery effort.

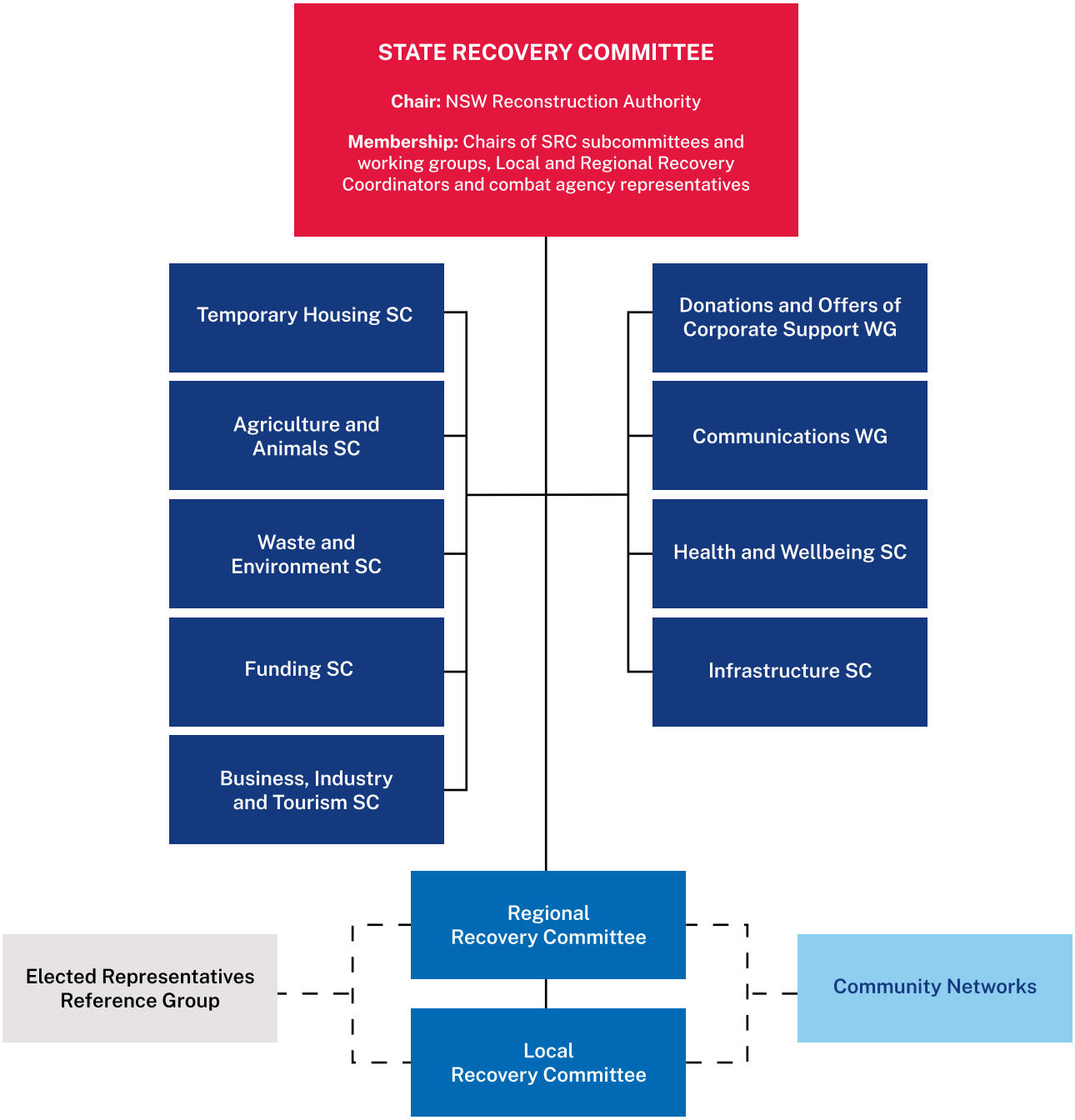


Figure 3: Schematic representation of the State Recovery Committee with local and regional structures, including working groups (WG) and subcommittees (SC) of the State Recovery Committee

3.8 Recovery Subcommittees and Working Groups

3.8.1. Recovery Committees at all levels may form subcommittees and working groups to focus on providing specialised support and advice to the Recovery Committee. The need for subcommittees is based on the impacts of the event.

3.8.2. Recovery subcommittee membership is determined by the Recovery Committee. Members include representatives from government and non-government organisations and have specific knowledge in one of the four recovery domains.

3.8.3. Representatives from the Recovery Committee will chair each of the subcommittees to coordinate and implement recovery tasks and disseminate decisions from the Recovery Committee as required. The chair of the subcommittee is also responsible for communicating information and issues up to the Recovery Committee and over to other relevant committees, where established.

3.8.4. It is important for the subcommittee structure to be agile. Therefore, depending on the impact of the disaster or emergency, the types of subcommittees and appropriate chairs may vary.

3.8.5. Working Groups may also be formed under Recovery Committees, with specific remits or deliverables. The chairs of these working groups are responsible for communicating information and issues up to the Recovery Committee and to other relevant committees.

3.8.6. The groupings in Figure 4 can be replicated or adapted as required.

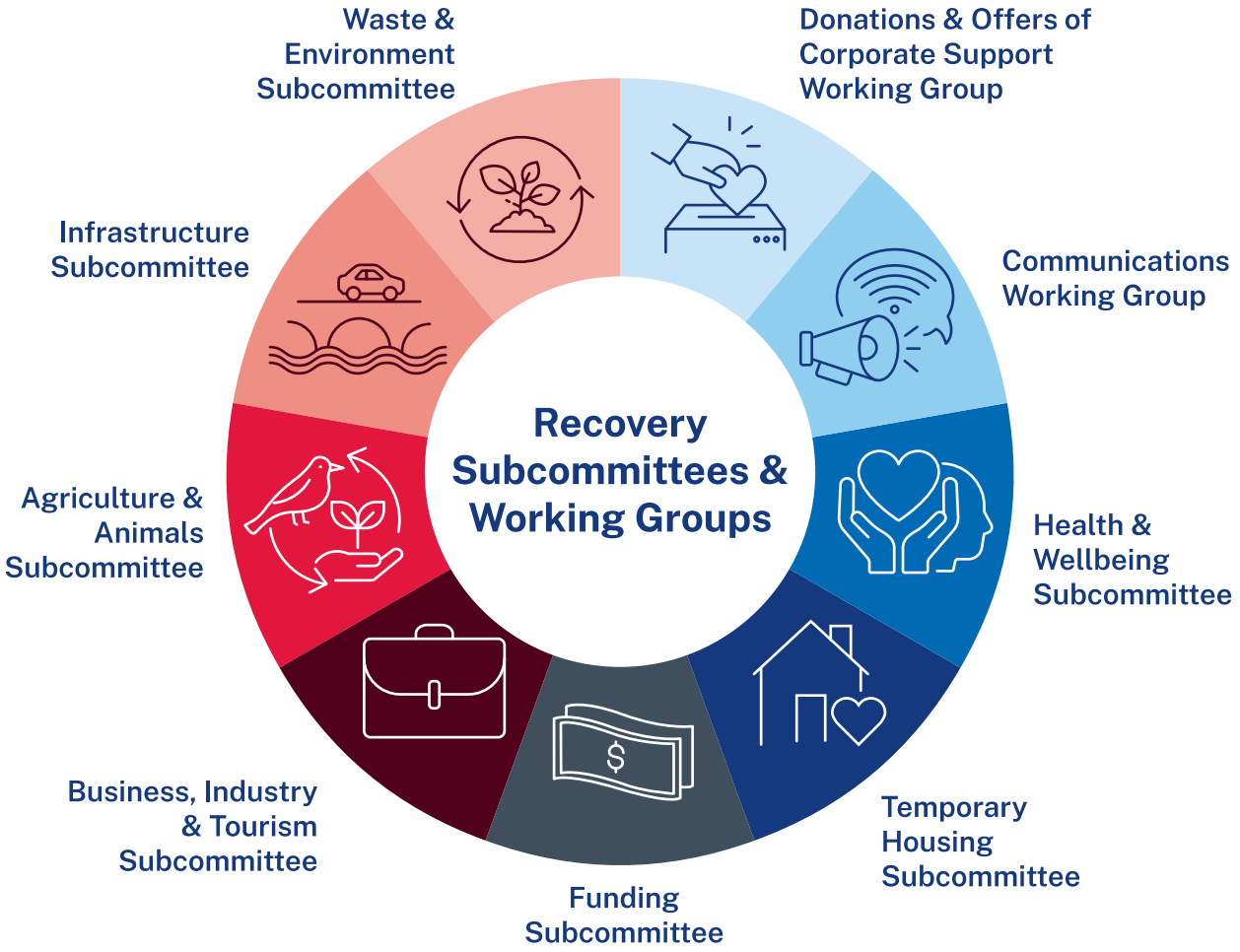


Figure 4: Recovery subcommittees and working groups which may be established by local, regional, and state recovery committees

3.9 National Structures

3.9.1. The National Cabinet is chaired by the Prime Minister and includes the Premiers and Chief Ministers from each state and territory.

3.9.2. The National Emergency Management Ministers Meeting is the national ministerial-level committee responsible for development of policy and arrangements relating to emergencies in Australia.

3.9.3. The Australian and New Zealand Emergency Management Committee (ANZEMC) works to strengthen the resilience of each nation by providing strategic leadership on emergency management policy and supporting related capability and capacity development activities. It comprises representatives from the commonwealth, state and territory governments, New Zealand Government, and the Australian Local Government Association.

3.9.4. The ANZEMC has a specific mandate to promote and consider community-centred disaster recovery policy and planning in keeping with the National Principles for Disaster Recovery.

3.10 Recovery at the National Level

3.10.1. The *National Catastrophic Natural Disaster Plan* describes the national coordination arrangements for supporting both the NSW Government and Australian Government in responding to and recovering from catastrophic natural disasters in Australia.

3.10.2. The *National Emergency Declaration Act 2020* enables the Governor-General to declare a national emergency on the advice of the Prime Minister. The *National Emergency Declaration Act 2020* allows Commonwealth agencies to waive certain bureaucratic requirements.

3.10.3. The *National Emergency Declaration Act 2020* also allows Commonwealth entities to be compelled to report on certain information.

4 Roles and Responsibilities

4.1 Local Council

4.1.1. Local councils play a key role in leading, managing and supporting their community's local recovery, providing services and assistance to the community and advice and advocacy to the NSW Government. RA staff provide direct support to and work closely with councils to lead and manage local recovery.

4.1.2. Local council will chair the Local Recovery Committee. If council elects not to chair, the RA or a Recovery Coordinator will assume this responsibility.

4.1.3. Local council provides expertise and local knowledge to inform the Local Recovery Committee.

4.1.4. Local council provides executive support to the Local Recovery Committees, as needed.

4.2 State Emergency Recovery Controller

4.2.1. Section 20A of the SERM Act states that the Office of the State Emergency Recovery Controller (SERCON) is to be held by the Chief Executive Officer of the NSW Reconstruction Authority, unless delegated.

4.2.2. The responsibilities of the SERCON are detailed in Section 20B of the SERM Act and the EMPLAN.

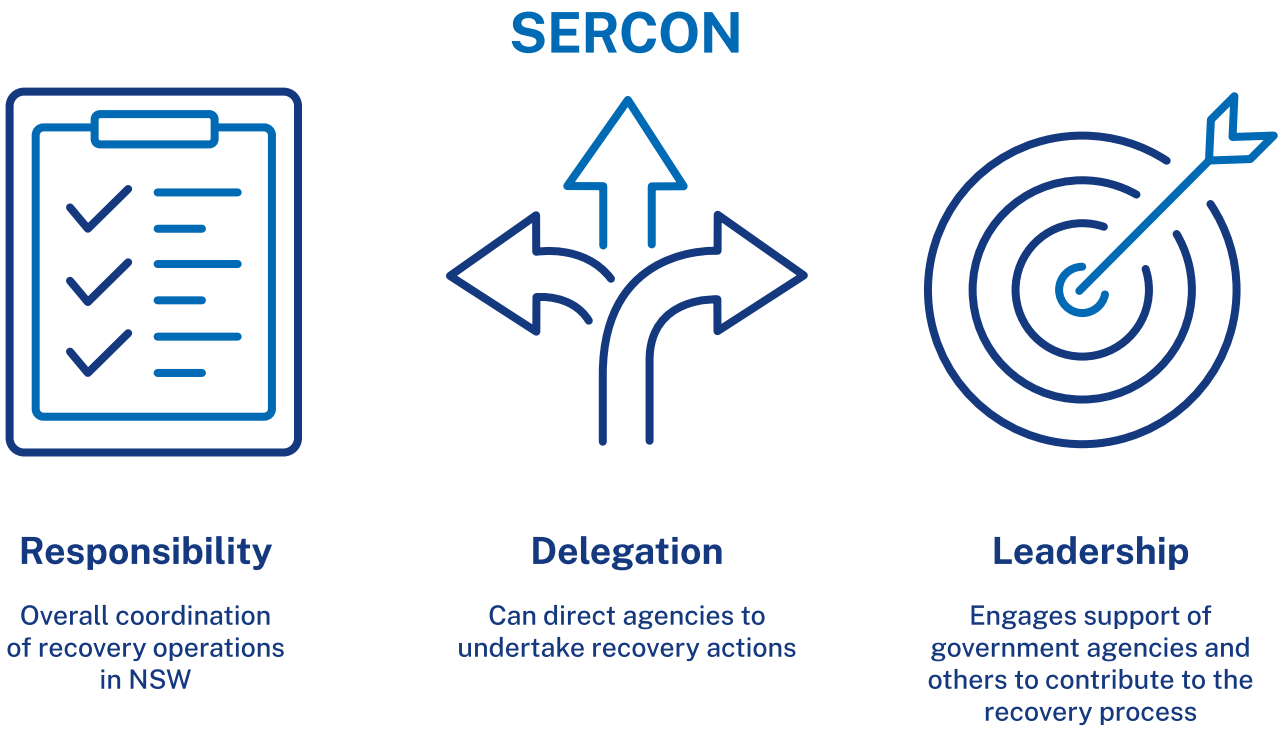


Figure 5: The SERCON is responsible for controlling the recovery from a natural disaster or other emergency

4.3 NSW Government Agencies

4.3.1. The EMPLAN outlines the roles and responsibilities of agencies within NSW that have a role in emergency management.

4.3.2. Recovery is a whole-of-government activity and may require participation and involvement of all government agencies, depending on the nature and impact of the event. All NSW Government agencies and statutory bodies need to maintain the capacity and capability to participate in the recovery effort, as directed by the SERCON and as per agency plans.

4.3.3. The SERCON and DSERCON may request that agencies provide staff and subject matter experts to support the work of the Recovery Coordinator(s).

4.3.4. Under Section 14 of the Act, every government agency, local council, and state-owned corporation is required to cooperate with the RA in relation to its recovery functions following a disaster.

Functional Areas



4.3.5. The SERCON will coordinate recovery activities throughout the state and will be supported by the State Emergency Operations Centre (SEOC) and the following functional areas:

- Agriculture and Animal Services
- Telecommunications Services
- Energy and Utility Services
- Engineering Services
- Environmental Services
- Health Services
- Public Information Services
- Transport Services
- Welfare Services.

4.3.6. A number of NSW Government agencies also support recovery functions as part of their core business.

NSW Reconstruction Authority



4.3.7. The RA is responsible for providing support to the Minister for Emergency Services and the SERCON by:

a. providing senior leadership to facilitate whole-of-government coordination

b. coordinating formal recovery processes at the direction of the SERCON. Coordination should prioritise community-centred recovery and may include coordination at the local, regional or state level.

c. developing and maintaining recovery policies, plans and arrangements

d. resourcing one or more Recovery Coordinator positions. Recovery Coordinators will be identified by the SERCON as required. Recovery Coordinators will usually be drawn from within the ranks of the RA (however, the SERCON may consult with the Minister on these appointments as necessary and required). Recovery Coordinators will be supported in their role by RA staff.

e. providing recovery management and operational expertise to Local and Regional Recovery Committees

f. administering and delivering temporary housing solutions

g. administering and delivering recovery programs such as Recovery Support Services, Community Recovery Officers and Disaster Relief Grants

h. maintaining operational oversight and disseminating operational reports to key stakeholders

i. share information and liaise with elected officials to enhance communication arrangements back to the community

j. preparing progress and other reports associated with recovery operations

k. coordinating the analysis of impact assessment data to inform operational and non-operational recovery planning

l. coordinating the analysis of Recovery Needs Assessment data to inform operational and non-operational recovery planning

m. monitoring and evaluating state-funded recovery programs

n. implementing a lessons management process for recovery

o. leading whole-of-government communications and messaging during recovery

p. providing a point of contact for Australian Government agencies in relation to recovery issues and requests. These Commonwealth counterparts will include, but not be limited to, the National Emergency Management Agency (NEMA).

4.4 Recovery Coordinators

4.4.1. A Recovery Coordinator coordinates recovery operations on behalf of the state government in an impacted area.

4.4.2. Depending on the scale of the emergency, a Recovery Coordinator can be appointed at either or both local and regional levels. A Recovery Coordinator and their team provide advice, support, guidance and resources to assist the efforts of the Local Recovery Committee and the local council. This includes supporting local council to facilitate community recovery service models.

4.4.3. A Recovery Coordinator's functions are to:

- **a.** in consultation with the lead response agency, support the transition from the response phase to formal recovery
- **b.** establish and maintain an effective relationship with local council and other key community leaders, groups and organisations to facilitate community-centred recovery
- **c.** chair the Local Recovery Committee when required
- **d.** chair the Regional Recovery Committee
- **e.** oversee the implementation of Recovery Needs Assessments
- **f.** coordinate the development of Recovery Action Plans
- **g.** support the RA to maintain an operational picture of the impact and keep Local and/or Regional Recovery Committees informed
- **h.** communicate key messages to identified audiences in accordance with the agreed public information strategy
- **i.** establish regular dialogue with key stakeholders and opportunities for input and influence to ensure their understanding of, participation in, and contribution to the recovery process
- **j.** establish regular communication and engagement with NSW Government agency representatives
- **k.** assist with the facilitation and coordination of non-government and private sector organisations' to support their role in the recovery process, leverage their insights in relation to gaps and concerns, and enable their input to ongoing recovery planning.
- **l.** brief the SRC and escalate unresolved issues and risks
- **m.** identify areas where existing policy provisions are unlikely to be sufficient to achieve the requisite level of recovery and provide advice to the SERCON
- **n.** at the conclusion of the official recovery phase, provide a report to the SERCON detailing actions taken, lessons identified and recommended mitigation measures.

4.5 State Emergency Operations Controller

4.5.1. The State Emergency Operations Controller (SEOCON) is established under the SERM Act and staffed by the Commissioner of Police or a Senior Executive Service member of the NSW Police Force.

4.5.2. The SEOCON and SERCON will liaise during the response phase of an emergency.

4.5.3. For emergencies for which the SEOCON is controlling, the SEOCON is responsible for ensuring initial impact assessments are completed following an emergency, to inform recovery arrangements.

4.5.4. If an emergency response, of which the SEOCON is controlling, is ongoing and a recovery operation is likely to be initiated, the SEOCON coordinates impact assessments in conjunction with the SERCON.

4.5.5. The SEOCON facilitates the handover from response to recovery for emergencies of which the SEOCON has control. If required, the SEOCON may choose to delegate a relevant Emergency Operations Controller (EOCON) to conduct the handover on their behalf.

4.6 Combat Agencies

4.6.1. The combat agency will undertake relief activities, including make safe works to ensure that it is safe to commence the transition to formal recovery arrangements.

4.6.2. The combat agency will provide Recovery Committees with information about continuing response activities, guidance on mitigation strategies and general advice and assistance.

4.6.3. The combat agency provides appropriate information on the scale and impact of an event to the RA and relevant local, regional or state recovery committees.

4.6.4. The combat agency provides appropriate representation at local, regional or state recovery committees.

4.7 Australian Government

4.7.1. The Australian Government (through NEMA) is responsible for administering the Disaster Recovery Funding Arrangements (DRFA). These arrangements provide a financial safety net which supports significant recovery efforts within NSW.

4.7.2. The Australian Defence Force (ADF) has capabilities and resources that can be useful in providing assistance during recovery from natural disasters. The ADF provides this support under the Defence Assistance to the Civil Community (DACC) arrangements.

4.8 Non-Government and Not-For-Profit Organisations

4.8.1. Social service NGOs play an important role in supporting affected communities, particularly vulnerable community members who can be disproportionately impacted by disasters. Support may include practical assistance such as financial or food relief, psychosocial support, assistance with clean up, legal advice, tenancy support or financial counselling. Social service organisations also provide specialist support for issues that can escalate in the wake of disasters including domestic violence, homelessness, parenting challenges, educational disengagement and child neglect.

4.8.2. These organisations are often longstanding, locally based, community managed and highly trusted by their communities. As such they play an important role in building connection, social cohesion and a sense of belonging, which are critical factors in effective community-centred recovery efforts. They are also rich sources of valuable data and intelligence on local culture, needs, challenges and strengths.

4.8.3. Relationships with NGOs and not-for-profit organisations can be managed through a range of formal agreements, including Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs), service contracts and other arrangements, recognising that resourcing to respond to rising demand is an ongoing challenge. Regardless, building collaborative, mutually respectful relationships is key.

5 Recovery Funding and Financial Arrangements

5.1 Recovery Funding and Financial Arrangements

5.1.1. The RA is the NSW Government agency responsible for recovery funding and recovery arrangements. This responsibility includes liaising with NEMA to coordinate the DRFA and the National Partnership Agreement. Ongoing policy advice, direction and support will be provided for administering agencies as part of their role in delivering the DRFA.

5.1.2. The DRFA is an Australian Government instrument that provides a financial safety net to states and territories, enabling certain expenditure above defined financial thresholds to be reimbursed, if relevant criteria are met.

5.1.3. NSW expenditure must meet the eligibility criteria and exceed certain thresholds to be eligible for Commonwealth assistance under DRFA. A Natural Disaster Declaration triggers the DRFA and is made once the eligibility criteria are met. The small disaster criterion is a minimum of $240,000 public infrastructure damage, response, and recovery costs. The SERCON provides advice to the Minister for Emergency Services as to whether the threshold has been met and a natural disaster can be declared.

5.1.4. The DRFA also includes provisions for reimbursement in circumstances where extraordinary costs are incurred in connection with Counter Disaster Operations. In such circumstances, funding may be available to assist with minimal suppression works and restoration (commonly referred to as 'Make Safe Works'). Make Safe Works are an essential precursor to the more formalised recovery effort. These works may be undertaken by combat agencies, local councils and/or private contractors engaged by those authorities.

5.1.5. NSW Disaster Assistance Guidelines reflects the DRFA and includes arrangements administered directly through NSW Government departments. More information on the assistance available can be found at nsw.gov.au/disaster-recovery/disaster-relief-and-support

5.1.6. The NSW Disaster Assistance Guidelines has established a range of relief measures designed to address impacts on:

- individuals and households
- small businesses
- primary producers
- local councils
- community organisations.

5.1.7. Expenditure of funds by agencies during recovery operations is to be met in the first instance by the agency from within their normal operating budgets or arrangements with NSW Treasury. NSW Treasury may provide additional funding if the expenditure is of a magnitude that prevents the agencies or functional areas from continuing their normal operations for the remainder of the financial year. Agencies cannot be guaranteed that funding will be provided.

6 Triggers, Coordination and Announcements

6.1 Transition from Response to Recovery

6.1.1. The recovery process begins at impact. It operates in parallel to the response phase and continues long after the response phase is complete. The combat agency retains responsibility until it advises the SERCON and/or Recovery Coordinator (if appointed) that the identified response phase is complete, and the area is now safe.

6.1.2. The SERCON may, in consultation with the EOCON and/or Incident Controller (or delegate), deploy a Recovery Liaison Officer to the most appropriate Emergency Operations Centre or Combat Agency Operations Centre, as necessary.

6.1.3. The combat agency, or EOCON when in control, is to provide information on the response operation to the Recovery Liaison Officer. This data, including damage and impact assessment information, should be used as a basis for planning recovery and feed into the Recovery Needs Assessment. The EOCON should support the combat agency and functional areas on request to develop the impact assessment.

6.1.4. As the response concludes, a transition to recovery will be formalised. In events of medium and high severity, this process will be formally documented and recorded.

6.1.5. The combat agency, or EOCON when in control, will provide the SERCON/Recovery Coordinator with a detailed handover brief and associated data to facilitate the seamless transition of management responsibility to the SERCON.

6.1.6. The SERCON, the SEOCON and relevant Combat Agency Controller will ensure that senior representatives from the combat agency are assigned as Liaison Officers to attend the relevant Recovery Committee and engage with the Recovery Coordinator (if appointed) throughout the transition.

6.1.7. The SERCON will ensure that a coordinated public information strategy is developed and implemented to assure the community that services are still available, despite the withdrawal of emergency response agencies.

6.1.8. Where possible, the transition from response to recovery should occur at the lowest level.

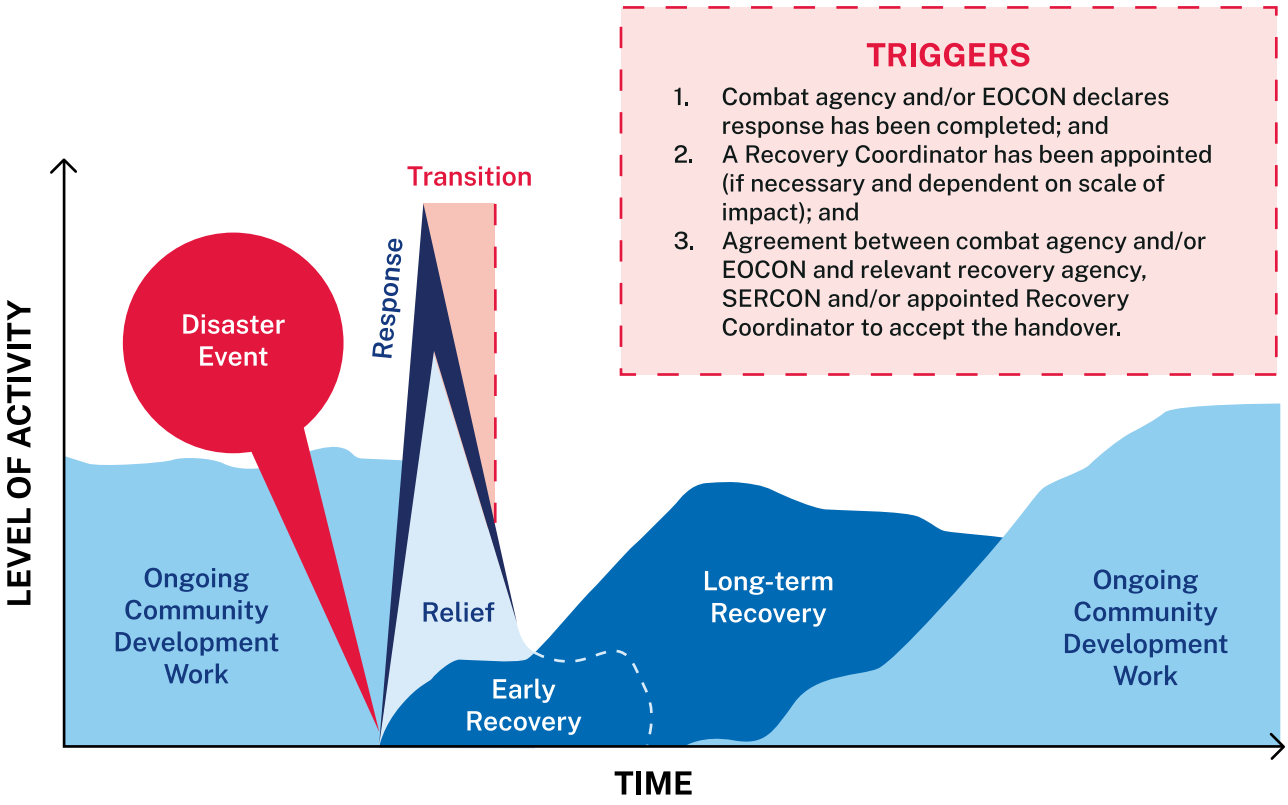


Figure 6: Demonstrates the transition from response to recovery in the context of recovery relative to time, highlighting that recovery begins at the impact of a disaster or other emergency and continues over time. Relief activities may be ongoing following the transition from response to early recovery. The transition from long-term recovery to ongoing community development work signals the progressive handover of recovery activities to the community.

6.2 Triggers for Transition

6.2.1. The transition from response to recovery will commence when:

- **a.** The combat agency, or EOCON when in control, determines that the response has been completed and,
- **b.** A Recovery Coordinator has been appointed (if necessary and dependent on scale of impact) and/or,
- **c.** Agreement between combat agency, or EOCON when in control, and relevant recovery agency, SERCON and/or appointed Recovery Coordinator to accept the handover.

6.2.2. Where a Recovery Coordinator has not been appointed, the combat agency and/or EOCON will provide advice to the SERCON or delegate.

6.2.3. The combat agency and/or EOCON can determine that the response has been completed at a 'sector' level. A sector may include a region, LGA, suburb or street, depending on the size of the event and scale of the impact.

6.2.4. Relief activities may be ongoing prior to, during and following the transition to recovery. Following the transition from response to recovery, relief activities will be coordinated by the RA. Relief activities may typically include ongoing clean up, damage assessment, addressing welfare and emergency housing needs and public health needs. Relief activities will be delivered by relevant combat agencies and/or functional areas.

6.2.5. The transition to recovery is completed and official upon public announcement. The public announcement may be delivered by a variety of mediums including broadcast, print media and social media.

6.3 Recovery Coordination Models

Low Severity Activation

6.3.1. Where an event impacts a single LGA or causes limited disruption to communities and damage to physical infrastructure, the affected local council leads the recovery operations, and where possible, from its own resources. A Local Recovery Committee may be established. The most appropriate recovery service model will be activated to provide services to affected communities.

6.3.2. The RA will support local councils through its regionally based teams. Other NSW government agencies may assist recovery operations, through existing local resources. State agency activities are handled through business-as-usual channels.

6.3.3. The Combat Agency Controller and LEOCON or their delegates attend initial recovery committee meetings to provide an overview of the emergency response operation.

6.3.4. The Regional Emergency Management Officer (REMO) and appropriate functional area delegates are invited to the initial local meeting and to subsequent meetings, as required.

6.3.5. The SERCON may determine to appoint a Recovery Coordinator to:

- attend the LEMC, Local Recovery Committee and subsequent recovery meetings
- provide expert recovery advice and guidance to support community-centred recovery efforts
- produce regular situation reports in support of the recovery effort.

Medium Severity Activation

6.3.6. Where a single event or multiple events moderately impact one or multiple LGAs and there is a moderate disruption to communities and physical infrastructure, the combat agency / EOCON, in consultation with the RA, identifies the need for assistance from the state to provide resourcing for the affected local council and advises recovery operations. The most appropriate recovery service model will be activated to provide services to affected communities. The SERCON may decide to confirm the appointment of a Recovery Coordinator.

6.3.7. State agencies are widely engaged in recovery operations and have deployed additional personnel to coordinate activities.

6.3.8. The SERCON directs the Recovery Coordinator to support, advise and guide local recovery efforts and to coordinate recovery operations.

6.3.9. A Local Recovery Committee is established and is working with local stakeholders and the Recovery Coordinator (or RA) to develop a Recovery Action Plan. There may also be need for a Regional Recovery Committee to be established if the event impacts multiple LGAs.

6.3.10. The Local and Regional Recovery Committees will work closely with Recovery Coordinators to coordinate recovery efforts.

High Severity Activation

6.3.11. Where a major event or multiple events have affected numerous LGAs or regions, causing widespread disruption to communities and damage to physical infrastructure, and require a coordinated recovery effort that is beyond the capacity of Local and Regional Recovery Committees to manage. A Recovery Centre(s) and/ or other recovery service model(s) and programs are required to provide services to affected communities.

6.3.12. The NSW Government assumes responsibility for overall coordination of recovery operations, with extensive commitment of personnel and resources to the recovery effort. The SERCON directs the appointment of one or many Recovery Coordinator(s) and may consult with the Minister on these appointments.

6.3.13. The Local Recovery Committee retains a central role developing Recovery Action Plans and ensuring local recovery activities are coordinated with state efforts.

6.3.14. Upon consulting with the SRC, the SERCON will provide strategic advice to the Minister and the government on key recommendations around recovery priorities, programs and longer-term recovery actions.

Catastrophic Severity Activation

6.3.15. Should an event exceed the NSW Government's capacity to manage recovery within existing arrangements, the government may implement enhanced state-led arrangements. This may take the form of a high-level Disaster Recovery Government Coordination Taskforce, which brings together relevant subject matter expertise to expedite recovery and ensure a whole-of-government approach.

6.4 Stages of Recovery

6.4.1. The NSW Government recognises that communities recover at different rates due to many factors, including planning and preparedness prior to an event.

6.4.2. Understanding the stages of recovery enables recovery leaders to take a more proactive approach to recovery delivery, planning programs and facilitating recovery coordination.

6.4.3. Recovery generally spans three key stages. Each stage requires different activities to meet evolving community needs. These activities are informed through data and it is important to acknowledge that data requirements evolve as recovery transitions between stages. The stages (Figure 7) are:

- **Short-Term:** necessary activities within the first few weeks or months following a disaster
- **Medium Term:** necessary activities some months after the disaster event, and what planning activities need to be undertaken as the recovery operation continues
- **Long-Term:** looking at key milestones including the commencement, continuation or conclusion of reconstruction for the built environment, the gradual cessation of funding and grant programs and the transition back to longer-term locally-led community development work.

6.4.4. Relief activities to meet the most basic needs of the community including emergency accommodation, initial clean up and emergency stabilisation works, are delivered during the response phase. Relief activities are led by functional areas, combat agencies or other government departments.

6.4.5. Relief activities may be ongoing during the early stages of recovery, for example, emergency accommodation and clean up. Following the transition from response to recovery, the RA will coordinate these activities, but the delivery of services remains the responsibility of the relevant functional area, combat agency or other government agency.

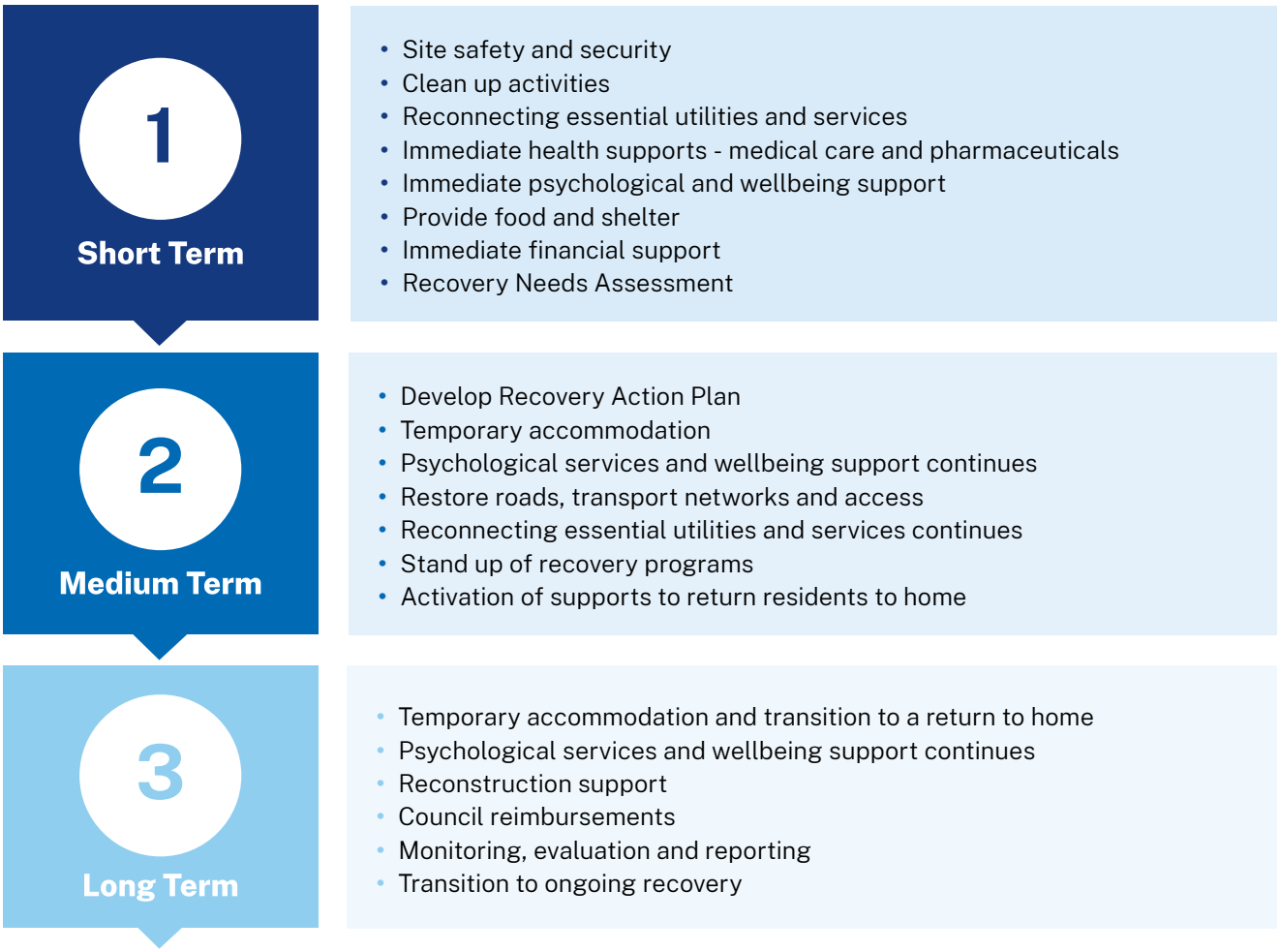


Figure 7: Recovery activities and outputs may be sequenced across three key stages of recovery to support the evolving needs of disaster impacted communities

6.5 Public Information

6.5.1. Public information strategies will be developed following natural disasters or other emergencies as part of the recovery planning process. These public information strategies will be coordinated by the Recovery Public Information Coordinator (RPIC) and support the effective management, coordination and release of key messages that are timely and accurate.

6.5.2. The RPIC will work in partnership with the Crisis Communications Executive Committee to coordinate all agencies that have a role in recovery in developing public communications.

6.5.3. The Local Recovery Committee and Recovery Coordinator (if appointed) are to work together to ensure that key messages are aligned and that public communication provides accurate and credible information regarding the services available to assist recovery. Where response is occurring concurrently in neighbouring communities, a coordinated approach to public information between response and recovery leads is essential.

6.6 Transition to Ongoing Recovery



6.6.1. A transition strategy is a systematic plan to achieve the withdrawal of formal government recovery arrangements. This strategy is to be documented in the Recovery Action Plan. Withdrawal of formal recovery arrangements requires a handover of the activities to agencies that usually have responsibility for those activities, under normal circumstances.

6.6.2. Recovery Committees will establish a timeframe for transition.

6.6.3. The transition strategy outlines the handover of responsibilities for the following:

- Recovery Coordinator(s)
- the local/regional/state recovery committee(s).

6.6.4. The SERCON will oversee the gradual reduction in recovery operations from the state level.

6.6.5. Responsibility for leading ongoing local recovery rests with the local/regional Recovery Committee.

6.6.6. In circumstances where local councils require additional support to facilitate the ongoing recovery process, this support will be provided by the NSW Government.

6.6.7. The transition from formal recovery structures is staged and conducted in consultation with the local council and Local Recovery Committee and in conjunction with an appropriate communications strategy.

6.6.8. Ultimately, recovery will conclude when the community acknowledges they have achieved a recovered state.

6.6.9. Data, information, and lessons identified during the recovery phase should be shared with the relevant local councils, combat agencies and the community, and be factored into future planning for prevention, preparedness and mitigation activities.

6.6.10. Prevention, preparedness and effective planning for future events can reduce or avoid event impacts and significantly influence more positive and effective recovery outcomes in the future, especially when past recovery data and lessons are included in preparedness planning.

7 Recovery Operations

7.1 Recovery Needs Assessment

7.1.1. A Recovery Needs Assessment is required to inform planning for the provision of basic recovery services. The needs assessment will be based on the impact assessments completed during the response phase by the combat agency and EOCON, or delegate.

7.1.2. Developing the Recovery Action Plan and designing an appropriate recovery service model relies on an accurate understanding of the impact of the event and context of the community, or communities, it has affected.

7.1.3. Damage and impact assessments will be completed throughout the response phase and during the transition to recovery by the lead combat agency and functional areas, supported by the EOCON.

7.1.4. The Recovery Coordinator (or RA) is responsible for undertaking and updating the Recovery Needs Assessment with the support of the RA. It is critical that this work is community-centred and community-informed.

7.1.5. For a Recovery Needs Assessment to be effective, it relies on timely, accurate and relevant intelligence and data provided by a range of sources.

7.2 Recovery Action Plan

7.2.1. The Recovery Action Plan provides the strategic direction and details actions required to facilitate recovery at local, regional and/or the state level.

7.2.2. Recovery Action Plans will be informed by local Pre-Event Recovery Plans.

7.2.3. A key activity for Recovery Coordinators is to develop a Recovery Action Plan with Local and Regional Recovery Committees that detail priorities, resource allocation and management at the local and regional level.

7.2.4. The Recovery Action Plan is unique to each event and guided by the ongoing needs of the community. It is a living document that changes over time. Local council plays a critical role in ensuring the local context and needs are accurately represented in this plan. Depending on the size and scale of the event, it may include some or all four of the recovery domains (social, built, economic and natural) and a recovery delivery model.

7.2.5. Recovery Action Plans are used by Recovery Committees to:

- Prioritise recovery activities to maximise the efficient use of resources
- Track all recovery activities being undertaken by government agencies, local councils, relevant community groups and NGOs.

7.2.6. The recovery delivery model should provide relevant, appropriate and effective assistance across the different recovery environments to strengthen community capability and capacity for recovery.

7.3 Recovery Delivery Model

7.3.1. The RA uses a multi-channel, flexible approach to recovery to ensure that all members of disaster impacted communities are supported by the relevant recovery services. Impacted individuals and communities can expect to receive support either in person, over the phone, online, or via a combination of these modes. Support can be tailored depending on the nature and impact of the event, the community demographic and their individual community needs.

7.3.2. Recovery Coordinators or the RA should consider information, including Pre-Event Recovery Plans and impact assessments, to inform recovery activities.

7.3.3. Recovery Centres and Recovery Assistance Points are designed to centralise local, state and Commonwealth government and non-government services and enable people affected by disasters to access one-on-one support and recovery services, including:

- financial assistance and advice
- temporary housing advice and support
- personal support (care and comfort)
- referral to mental health and counselling services
- insurance enquiries
- primary production assistance
- legal services
- business support.

7.3.4. The nature of the event and its impact on the community will determine which multi-channel support mechanisms are utilised.

7.3.5. Recovery Centres and Recovery Assistance Points may be supplemented or replaced by alternative support mechanisms, where required. These alternatives include, but are not limited to, community meetings, Community Networks, telephone support services and/or bespoke options, such as property visits.

7.3.6. In circumstances where a Recovery Centre or Recovery Assistance Point is required, local council will provide the facility. The RA and the Engineering Services Functional Area work with local councils to identify a suitable location and complete fit-out works. Recovery Centres and Recovery Assistance Points are coordinated and managed by the RA.

7.4 Recovery Program Model

7.4.1. Sometimes communities require medium to long-term support (depending on the scale of the event).

7.4.2. Recovery programs can be developed and implemented to provide the support needed by community. These programs include a range of off-the-shelf supports that can be quickly delivered. More targeted and bespoke programs can be developed to meet specific recovery needs. Recovery programs cover the four recovery domains.

7.4.3. Recovery programs are informed by data and intelligence, captured throughout the course of the response phase and as recovery activities continue.

7.5 Temporary Housing



7.5.1. The NSW Government can provide a range of temporary housing solutions to support those impacted by natural disasters and other emergencies, from shortly after the point of impact through to the medium-term of their recovery.

7.5.2. Temporary housing solutions should focus resources on supporting people to return home as soon as possible. Temporary housing programs seek to supplement return home and repair initiatives in cases where there is an ongoing housing need directly related to a disaster that cannot be met through alternative support.

7.6 Mental Health in Recovery



7.6.1. The changing nature of climate related and natural disasters has led to events that are longer lasting with cumulative effects on vulnerable individuals and communities. A significant proportion of disaster impacted individuals will benefit from practical support and an approach based on the principles of Psychological First Aid. Those that experience more serious mental health impacts may need access to specialist mental health services.

7.6.2. The focus for mental health services in the first days and weeks after an event is to maintain access to specialist care while providing consultation and advice to welfare and support agencies in evacuation centres (see definitions) and Recovery Centres.

7.6.3. A range of mental health recovery programs are in place that work in partnership with primary health and community agencies and provide ongoing outreach and support, including pathways to specialist care as needed. These programs are developed in collaboration with local communities and focus on building resilience and skills to promote recovery of disaster impacted individuals and communities.

7.7 Recovery Resourcing

7.7.1. Support for recovery operations can be provided through resourcing arrangements. These arrangements are underpinned by the *Government Sector Employment Act 2013*, which provides for the temporary secondment of staff (Part 5, Section 66).

7.7.2. Interjurisdictional assistance (resourcing support from other Australian states and territories) is available through arrangements established by the Social Recovery Reference Group (SRRG). NSW can activate the SRRG Interjurisdictional Assistance arrangements to seek workforce assistance from other states and territories to assist with recovery operations.

7.8 Donations Management

7.8.1. Disasters often generate significant unsolicited donations that do not meet the specific needs of an affected community.

7.8.2. The management of unsolicited donated goods can divert valuable resources away from other critical recovery activities. Emergency management, local councils and recovery agencies should actively discourage material donations, as they require extensive logistical management and can reduce the capacity of a person's ability to manage their own recovery.

7.8.3. The NSW Government recommends monetary donations as a preferred method of support as it provides disaster-affected people with more flexibility and choice over their recovery and ensures funds are delivered where they're needed most.

7.8.4. The NSW Government has engaged a contractor to support donations management during disasters. Inquiries about the management of donations can be referred to the RA.

7.9 Spontaneous Volunteers

7.9.1. Volunteerism is at the heart of recovery activities immediately following an event. It is the role of the NSW Government to provide support to community-initiated recovery, to ensure that genuine community-centred recovery is encouraged and enabled.

7.9.2. Organised volunteer groups are key to providing relevant services which meet the specific needs of their communities. These groups should be leveraged to inform and where relevant, support recovery activities.

7.9.3. Where volunteers unaffiliated with organised groups attend the community to render assistance, they should be directed in the first instance to the Volunteer Coordinator, who is identified in the Pre-Event Recovery Plan.

7.10 Community Networks

7.10.1. The SERCON, Recovery Coordinator, the Regional or Local Recovery Committee will utilise local Community Networks (CNs) to enable members of the local community to provide input to the recovery process. This includes people affected by the event and representatives from local organisations.

7.10.2. CNs will also include community leaders who can provide a representative voice for their communities and will often play a key role in recovery activities.

7.10.3. Elected officials play an important role in CNs. Elected officials provide community with an additional avenue to bring recovery needs and issues to relevant recovery committees and provide information back to communities on recovery services and objectives.

7.10.4. The SERCON, Recovery Coordinator, Regional Recovery Committee or Local Recovery Committee will connect with and use the CN to understand impact, needs and capacity after a disaster.

7.10.5. CNs should be supported by the Recovery Coordinator or the chair of the Local Recovery Committee.

7.10.6. The CN is a platform that enables communities impacted by a disaster to have a voice in the recovery process. Community networks will:

- represent the community in the recovery process
- facilitate dialogue between the Local Recovery Committee and the community
- regularly advise on issues of concern
- work with the Local Recovery Committee and task groups to tackle specific issues
- assist with the coordination of recovery initiatives undertaken in the community.

7.10.7. CNs may be delivered using a variety of models, including Community Resilience Networks.

7.11 Community Hubs

7.11.1. A local council or organisation may establish a Community Hub, which is a place where impacted community members can seek information about different types of assistance that may be available.

7.11.2. Types of assistance accessed within a Community Hub vary and may include access to local support networks, local volunteering opportunities and the provision of material aid and donations.

7.11.3. Community Hubs are established and managed solely by local organisations, including the local council, and are often staffed by volunteers.

7.12 Cross-Border Communities

7.12.1. People and businesses in NSW border communities can experience adverse outcomes if neighbouring jurisdictions take different approaches to recovery and service delivery. In applying recovery arrangements, agencies should ensure the needs of border communities are considered and consult the Office of the Cross-Border Commissioner, if appropriate.

8 Training, Exercising and Evaluation

8.1 Training and Exercising

8.1.1. The NSW Recovery Plan and capabilities are routinely tested through operations, exercises and training. The results of these activities are reviewed by the SERCON, ensuring that recovery capabilities are appropriately maintained and developed.

8.1.2. Representatives from relevant CNs should be invited to exercises to develop community capacity.

8.1.3. Multi-agency exercises are considered best practice because the recovery function is rarely performed by one agency in isolation.

8.1.4. It is the responsibility of each agency with a role in recovery to ensure that it has enough appropriately trained staff to execute its responsibilities during operations.

8.2 Monitoring, Evaluation and Reporting

8.2.1. The NSW Government has developed the NSW Evaluation Policy and Guidelines to establish a monitoring and evaluation framework that guides activities over the life of an initiative.

8.2.2. Monitoring is a continuous and systematic process of collecting and analysing information about the implementation and impacts of an initiative. Monitoring may include a range of measures and indicators that track performance.

8.2.3. Monitoring can begin as soon as an initiative is implemented. Shared outcomes and correlating indicators will be monitored and reported against as part of the ongoing monitoring of recovery initiatives.

8.2.4. Evaluation is a systematic and transparent process used to assess the appropriateness, effectiveness, efficiency, and net benefits of an initiative once it has been implemented. Evaluation is most effective when the implementation and impacts of an initiative are monitored.

8.2.5. The RA will leverage this guidance and incorporate it into its monitoring and evaluation activities.

8.3 Reviewing the NSW Recovery Plan

8.3.1. As part of the RA's commitment to continuous improvement, the Plan will be reviewed and revised regularly (at least every three years), following a major event and/or at the discretion of the SERCON.

9 Definitions

Term	Definition
Agency	A government agency or a non-government agency. (Source: EMPLAN)
Combat agency	The agency identified in EMPLAN as the agency primarily responsible for controlling the response to a particular emergency. (Source: EMPLAN)
Community Networks	Community Networks are a flexible model that link local community leaders and organisations with NSW Government agencies and local councils, who are involved in recovery and resilience building. Community Networks provide a channel for the community to engage with emergency management structures including Local Emergency Management Committee and Local Recovery Committees. Community Networks enable agencies and organisations involved in recovery to understand community impacts, needs and capabilities. Community Networks may include the more formal Community Resilience Network model.
Communications strategy	A plan detailing efficient and effective dissemination of information to the affected community and the community at large, in respect to recovery measures and contact points, is essential.
Coordination	The bringing together of agencies and individuals to ensure effective emergency or rescue management but does not include the control of agencies and individuals by direction. (Source: EMPLAN)
Deputy State Emergency Recovery Controller (DSERCON)	A statutory position designated by the Chief Executive Officer of the NSW Reconstruction Authority and responsible for controlling the recovery from the emergency in accordance with Section 20A of the SERM Act.
Disaster	An occurrence, whether or not due to natural causes, that causes loss of life, injury, distress or danger to persons, or loss of, or damage to, property. (Source: EMPLAN)
Disaster Adaptation Plan	Disaster Adaptation Plans (DAPs) are designed for communities to better adapt to their specific risks and outline actions that can be taken at a local level. They can be prepared by a local council, another relevant entity, or the NSW Reconstruction Authority. They will be developed in line with framework and guidelines being prepared by the RA that consider legislative requirements. DAPs support the State Disaster Mitigation Plan.
Disaster recovery	The coordinated process of supporting disaster-affected communities in the reconstruction of the physical infrastructure and the restoration of emotional, social, economic, environmental, and physical wellbeing. (Source: AIDR)
Disaster Recovery Funding Arrangements (DRFA)	The Australian Government provides funding through the DRFA to help pay for natural disaster relief and recovery costs based on the terms and conditions in the Disaster Recovery Funding Arrangements 2018.
Disaster risk	The potential loss of life, injury, or destroyed or damaged assets which could occur to a system, society, or a community in a specific period of time, determined probabilistically as a function of hazard, exposure, vulnerability and capacity. The definition of disaster risk reflects the concept of hazardous events and disasters as the outcome of continuously present conditions of risk. (Source: United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction 2016)
EMPLAN	The NSW State Emergency Management Plan (EMPLAN). The object of EMPLAN is to ensure the coordinated response to emergencies by all agencies having responsibilities and functions in emergencies. (Source: EMPLAN)
Emergency	An actual or imminent occurrence (such as fire, flood, storm, earthquake, explosion, terrorist act, accident, epidemic or warlike action) which: • endangers, or threatens to endanger, the safety or health of persons or animals in the state, or • destroys or damages, or threatens to destroy or damage, any property in the state, or • causes a failure of, or a significant disruption to, an essential service or infrastructure • being an emergency, which requires a significant and co-ordinated response. For the purposes of the definition of emergency, property in the state includes any part of the environment of the state. Accordingly, a reference in the SERM Act to: • threats or danger to property includes a reference to threats or danger to the environment, and • the protection of property includes a reference to the protection of the environment. (Source: EMPLAN)

Term	Definition
Emergency Operations Centre (EOC)	A centre established at State, Region, or Local level as a centre of communication and as a centre for the coordination of operations and support during an emergency. (Source: EMPLAN)
Essential services	For the purposes of the *Essential services Act 1988*, a service is an essential service if it consists of any of the following: • the production, supply, or distribution of any form of energy, power or fuel or of energy, power or fuel resources • the public transportation of persons or freight • the provision of fire-fighting services • the provision of public health services (including hospital or medical services) • the provision of ambulance services • the production, supply or distribution of pharmaceutical products • the provision of garbage, sanitary cleaning, or sewerage services • the supply or distribution of water • the conduct of a welfare institution • the conduct of a prison • a service declared to be an essential service under subsection (2) • a service comprising the supply of goods or services necessary for providing any service referred to in paragraphs (a) – (k). (Source: EMPLAN)
Evacuation Centre	A centre set up at the request of a Combat Agency or EOCON to meet the immediate needs of disaster affected people following evacuation from an emergency. This may include travellers (commuters and tourists) who are unable to complete their journey. (Source: Welfare Services Functional Area Plan)
Functional area	The nominated coordinator of a functional area, tasked to coordinate the provision of functional area support and resources for emergency response and recovery operations, who, by agreement of participating and supporting organisations within the functional area, has the authority to commit the resources of those organisations. (Source: EMPLAN)
Functional Area Coordinator	The nominated coordinator of a functional area, tasked to coordinate the provision of functional area support and resources for emergency response and recovery operations who, by agreement of participating and supporting organisations within the functional area, has the authority to commit the resources of those organisations. (Source: EMPLAN)
Government agency	Means: • a Public Service agency • a public authority, being a body (whether incorporated or not) established by or under an Act for a public purpose, other than: — the Legislative Council or Legislative Assembly or a committee of either or both of — those bodies; or — a court or other judicial tribunal • the NSW Police Force • a local government council or other local authority; or • a member or officer of an agency referred to in paragraphs (a) – (d) or any other person in the service of the Crown who has statutory functions, other than: – the Governor, the Lieutenant-Governor, or the Administrator of the State – a Minister of the Crown – a Member of the Legislative Council or Legislative Assembly or an officer of that – Council or Assembly; or – a judicial officer. (Source: EMPLAN)
Hazard	A potential or existing condition that may cause harm to people or damage to property or the environment. (Source: EMPLAN)
Impact assessment	A continuous and dynamic process of ongoing information collection and assessment. It is coordinated by the EOCON with combat agency and functional areas contributing to the data collection process.

Term	Definition
Liaison Officer (LO)	A person nominated or appointed by an organisation or functional area to represent that organisation or functional area at a control centre, emergency operations centre, coordination centre or site control point. A liaison officer maintains communications with and conveys directions/requests to their organisation or functional area, and provides advice on the status, capabilities, actions and requirements of their organisation or functional area. (Source: EMPLAN)
Local Emergency Management Committee (LEMC)	The committee constituted under the State Emergency and Rescue Management Act, 1989 for each local government area, and is responsible for the preparation of plans in relation to the prevention of, preparation for, response to and recovery from emergencies in the local government area (Local EMPLAN) for which it is constituted. In the exercise of its functions, any such Committee is responsible to the relevant Region Emergency Management Committee. (Source: EMPLAN)
Local Emergency Operations Controller (LEOCON)	A police officer appointed by the Region Emergency Operations Controller as the Local Emergency Operations Controller for the Local Government Area. (Source: EMPLAN)
Local Government Area (LGA)	An area within the meaning of the *Local Government Act 1993* and includes a combined local government area as referred to in section 27 of the *State Emergency and Rescue Management Act, 1989*. (Source: EMPLAN)
Minister	The Minister for Emergency Services
Mitigation	Measures taken in advance of, or after, a disaster aimed at decreasing or eliminating its impact on society and environment. (Source: EMPLAN)
National Disaster Recovery Principles	A series of principles endorsed by the Australian and New Zealand Emergency Management Committee (ANZEMC), intended to apply at national, state and territory, regional and local levels. The Principles define a standard for good practice, as well as a basis for accountability and evaluation, and should underpin emergency management plans and arrangements at all levels. (Source: Australian Disaster Recovery Framework, October 2022)
NSW Reconstruction Authority	An agency constituted under the *NSW Reconstruction Authority Act 2022* which provides operational support to the SERCON during recovery, particularly operational support to local, region and state level recovery committees. It also provides policy, governance and operational support to the State Recovery Committee and its various subcommittees.
Non-government agency	A voluntary organisation or any other private individual or body, other than a government agency. (Source: EMPLAN)
Preparation	Arrangements or plans to deal with an emergency or the effects of an emergency. (Source: EMPLAN)
Prevention	The identification of hazards, the assessment of threats to life and property, and the taking of measures to reduce potential loss to life or property. (Source: EMPLAN)
Public awareness	The process of informing the community as to the nature of the hazard and actions needed to save lives and property prior to and in the event of disaster. (Source: EMPLAN)
Reconstruction	The medium and long-term rebuilding and sustainable restoration of resilient critical infrastructures, services, housing, facilities and livelihoods required for the full functioning of a community, or a society affected by a disaster, aligning with the principles of sustainable development. (Source: United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction 2016)
Recovery	The process of returning an affected community to its proper level of functioning after an emergency. (Source: EMPLAN)
Recovery Action Plan	A plan developed to provide the strategic direction and operational actions required to facilitate successful recovery at local, region and/or state level.
Recovery Centre	A one-stop-shop that centralises local, state and Commonwealth government and non-government services to support people affected by disasters. Recovery Centres may be supplemented or replaced by Recovery Assistance Points (scaled down versions of full Recovery Centres). Recovery Centres and Recovery Assistance Points are coordinated and managed by the RA.

Term	Definition
Recovery Committee	The strategic decision-making body for recovery, providing visible and strong leadership with a key role in restoring confidence to the community through assessing the consequences of the emergency and coordinating activities to rebuild, restore and rehabilitate the affected community.
Recovery Coordinator(s)	The public face of the recovery operation, providing leadership to the Local/Regional Recovery Committee and coordinating the recovery effort in accordance with agreed recovery plans. Appointed by the SERCON as required.
Recovery Needs Assessment	An assessment of the community as a result of an event, including effects, community demography, available resources and the pre-existing psychological state of the community. (Source: AIDR Community Recovery Handbook)
Recovery Plan	The plan outlining the strategic intent, responsibilities, authorities, and mechanisms for disaster recovery in NSW. The Recovery Plan refers to this Plan.
Region	The state is divided into regions as determined by the Minister by order published in the Gazette. Any such order may describe the boundaries of a region by reference to LGAs, maps or otherwise. (Source: EMPLAN)
Regional Emergency Management Committee (REMC)	The committee constituted under the SERM Act (as amended), which at regional level is responsible for preparing plans in relation to the prevention of, preparation for, response to and recovery from emergencies in the region (Region EMPLAN) for which it is constituted. In the exercise of its functions, any such committee is responsible to the State Emergency Management Committee. (Source: EMPLAN)
Regional Emergency Operations Controller (REOCON)	The Region Commander of Police appointed by the Commissioner of Police, as the Regional Emergency Operations Controller for the Emergency Management Region. (Source: EMPLAN)
Relief	Relief refers to the provision of essential support to meet the basic and immediate needs and safety of persons and animals affected by, or responding to, an emergency. (Source: EMPLAN)
Rescue	Means the safe removal of persons or domestic animals from actual or threatened danger of physical harm. (Source: SERM Act)
Response	In relation to an emergency includes the process of combating an emergency and of providing immediate relief for persons affected by an emergency. (Source: EMPLAN)
Risk	A concept used to describe the likelihood of harmful consequences arising from the interaction of hazards, communities, and the environment. (Source: EMPLAN)
Risk assessment	The process used to determine risk management priorities by evaluating and comparing the level of risk against predetermined standards, target risk levels or other criteria. (Source: EMPLAN)
Risk management	The systematic application of management policies, procedures and practices to the tasks of identifying, analysing, evaluating, treating and monitoring risk. (Source: EMPLAN)
Spontaneous volunteer	Individuals or groups of people who seek or are invited to contribute their assistance during and/or after an emergency and who are unaffiliated with any part of the existing official emergency management response and recovery system. They may or may not have relevant training, skills, or experience. (Source: EMPLAN)
State Disaster Mitigation Plan	The State Disaster Mitigation Plan identifies NSW's exposure to natural hazards and how the associated risk changes over time. The plan will identify the areas of highest risk and the potential risk reduction tools. A range of measures will be identified to either reduce impacts where possible or adapt and prepare where necessary. The SDMP will be supported by place-based regional or local Disaster Adaptation Plans (DAPs).
State Emergency Management Committee (SEMC)	The committee constituted under the SERM Act (as amended), as the principal committee established under this Act for the purposes of emergency management throughout the state, and, in particular, is responsible for emergency planning at state level. (Source: SERM Act)

Term	Definition
State Emergency Operations Controller (SEOCON)	The State Emergency Operations Controller is the Commissioner of Police and is responsible for controlling an emergency affecting more than one region or for which the SEOCON assumes responsibility. The SEOCON is to establish and control a State Emergency Operations Centre. (Source: SERM Act)
State Emergency Recovery Controller (SERCON)	The State Emergency Recovery Controller is the Chief Executive Officer of the NSW Reconstruction Authority and is responsible for controlling the recovery from the emergency in accordance with Section 20B of the SERM Act. (Source: SERM Act)
State Emergency and Rescue Management Act 1989 (SERM Act)	The underlying act for emergency management in NSW. It specifies responsibilities of the Minister and requirements of the EMPLAN.
Supporting organisation	Government departments and statutory authorities that provide specialist services to Agency Controllers or Functional Area Coordinators across hazards and functions. They are required to provide this support in line with their service delivery responsibilities. (Source: EMPLAN)
Supporting plan	A plan prepared by an agency/organisation or functional area, which describes the support that is to be provided to the controlling or coordinating authority during emergency operations. It is an action plan that describes how the agency/organisation or functional area is to be coordinated to fulfil the roles and responsibilities allocated. (Source: EMPLAN)
Vulnerability	Australian Institute of Disaster Resilience (AIDR) defines vulnerability as 'the characteristics of a person or group and their situation that influence their capacity to anticipate, cope with, resist and recover from the impact of a ... hazard'. Examples of vulnerabilities include low income, low literacy levels, being uninsured, homelessness and use of languages other than English. (Source: Australian Institute of Disaster Resilience, 2022)



More information

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